

IT SUPPORT FUNDAMENTALS

FULL VISUAL STUDY MANUAL

IT Support Cycle

Good support is a repeatable service process

Listen

Understand the user's issue

Record

Capture facts and impact

Diagnose

Check safe likely causes

Resolve

Apply an authorised fix

Verify

Confirm with the user

Document

Record outcome and lessons

Course Code	EDA-ITS-111
Level	Beginner to Intermediate
Duration	6 Weeks (19 Lessons)
Certificate	Professional Certificate in IT Support Fundamentals
Prerequisite	Computer Appreciation + Hardware Fundamentals
Learning Format	Classroom + Guided Help-Desk Practicals + Final Service-Desk Project

Safety and security standard: all practicals use authorised devices, fictional users and defensive support workflows. Learners must not request passwords or one-time codes, bypass controls, probe networks, test suspicious links or perform hazardous electrical repairs.

Course Introduction

IT Support Fundamentals prepares learners to provide safe, organised and professional first-line technology support. The course covers service desks, ticketing, prioritisation, troubleshooting, Windows and application support, peripherals, connectivity, accounts, email, remote support, customer service, security escalation, knowledge bases, asset records and reporting.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the role and structure of an IT support service.
- Create clear support tickets and prioritise incidents.
- Apply a structured first-line troubleshooting method.
- Support common desktop, application, peripheral and connectivity issues safely.
- Guide legitimate account recovery without collecting user secrets.
- Communicate professionally with users.
- Recognise issues that require technical or security escalation.
- Create knowledge-base and support records.
- Operate a fictional help desk from ticket opening to closure.

Course Structure

1. Lesson 1: Introduction to IT Support
2. Lesson 2: IT Support Roles and Service Desk Structure
3. Lesson 3: Support Tickets and Incident Logging
4. Lesson 4: Impact, Urgency and Prioritisation
5. Lesson 5: Troubleshooting Methodology
6. Lesson 6: Supporting Windows and Desktop Settings
7. Lesson 7: Application Support Fundamentals
8. Lesson 8: Printer and Peripheral Support
9. Lesson 9: Network and Internet Support Basics
10. Lesson 10: Account and Password Support
11. Lesson 11: Email and Communication Support
12. Lesson 12: Remote Support and User Consent
13. Lesson 13: Customer Service and Communication Skills
14. Lesson 14: Security Awareness for IT Support
15. Lesson 15: Escalation and Handover
16. Lesson 16: Knowledge Base and Self-Service Documentation
17. Lesson 17: Asset and Support Records
18. Lesson 18: Help-Desk Reporting and Service Improvement
19. Lesson 19: Final IT Support Help-Desk Project

Lesson 1: Introduction to IT Support

Introduction

IT support helps people use technology effectively by diagnosing problems, guiding users, maintaining service records and escalating issues that require specialist access.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of introduction to it support.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for introduction to it support.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: IT support is a service function, not only a repair activity.

Key point: A support professional needs technical knowledge, communication, patience and documentation skills.

Key point: Good support begins with understanding the user's actual problem rather than guessing.

Key point: Support staff should work only within authorised systems, accounts and organisational procedures.

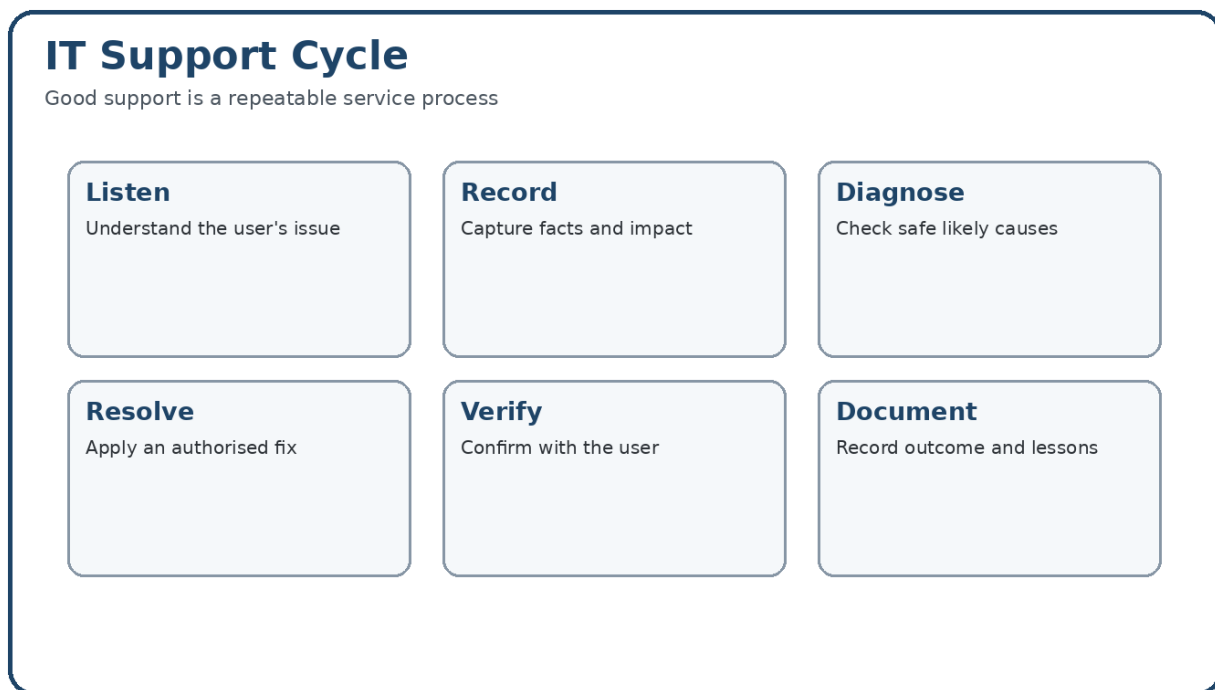


Figure 1: Instructional visual for Introduction to IT Support.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. List five problems an IT support desk may receive.
2. Classify each as hardware, software, account, network or user-guidance issue.
3. Write one sentence explaining the purpose of IT support.
4. Create a fictional support-desk name and contact process.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Ethan Digital Academy may need support for learner logins, classroom computers, projectors, printers, Wi-Fi and approved learning applications.

Review Questions

20. What is the main support goal in introduction to it support?
21. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
22. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
23. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 1 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Lesson 2: IT Support Roles and Service Desk Structure

Introduction

Support work can be organised into front-line help desk, technical escalation and specialist teams.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of it support roles and service desk structure.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for it support roles and service desk structure.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: First-line support handles common questions and safe standard fixes.

Key point: Second-line or specialist staff handle more complex issues requiring deeper access or expertise.

Key point: System administrators manage authorised infrastructure and accounts.

Key point: Security incidents should follow the organisation's security escalation route.

Key point: Clear role boundaries reduce unsafe or duplicated work.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Draw a three-level support structure.
2. Place five fictional issues at the correct level.
3. Identify which role should handle a damaged power supply.
4. Identify which role should handle a password reset under an approved process.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy reception or first-line staff can log an issue, while hardware repair or security incidents go to qualified staff.

Review Questions

24. What is the main support goal in it support roles and service desk structure?
25. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
26. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
27. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 2 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Lesson 3: Support Tickets and Incident Logging

Introduction

A ticket is a record of a support request. Clear tickets help teams understand what happened and what has already been tried.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of support tickets and incident logging.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for support tickets and incident logging.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: Record user or department, device, date/time, symptom and impact.

Key point: Use the user's words for the initial symptom, then add technical observations separately.

Key point: Avoid storing passwords, one-time codes or unnecessary personal data.

Key point: Record actions and results so another authorised technician can continue the case.

Key point: Close a ticket only after resolution or an agreed next step.

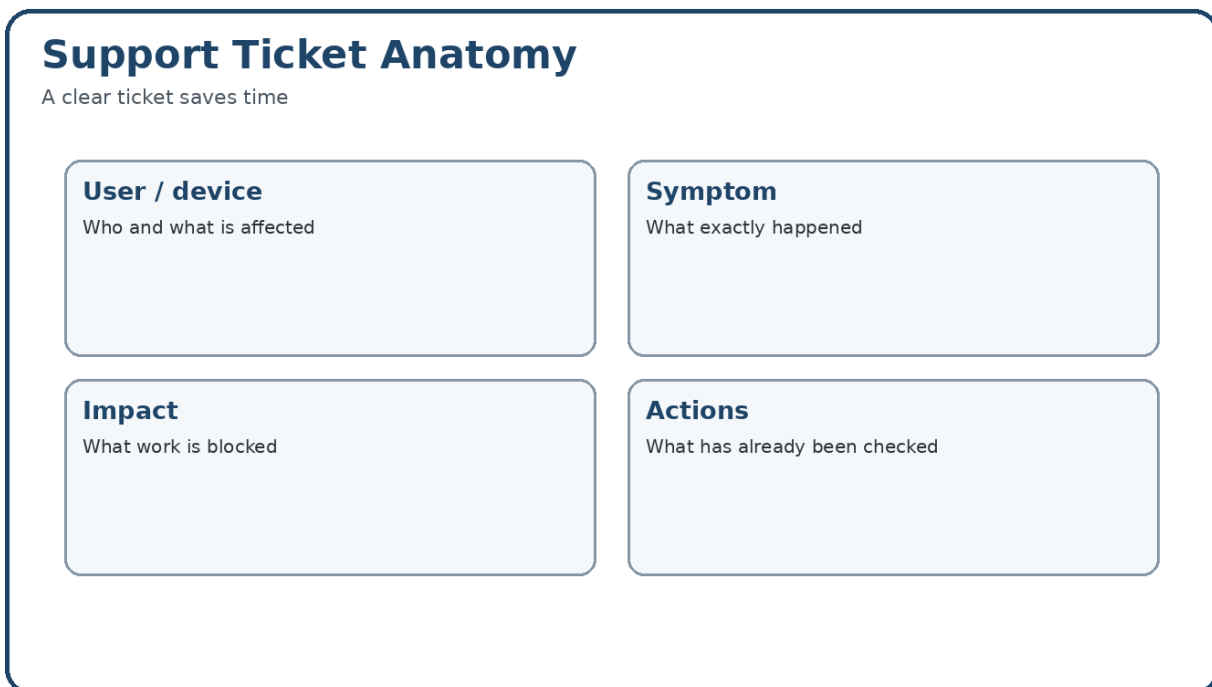


Figure 3: Instructional visual for Support Tickets and Incident Logging.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a fictional ticket for 'projector shows no image'.
2. Add device, room, symptom and impact.
3. Record two safe checks.
4. Write a resolution or escalation note.
5. Review the ticket for clarity.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

An Academy ticket history can show whether the same classroom device repeatedly fails.

Review Questions

28. What is the main support goal in support tickets and incident logging?
29. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
30. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
31. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 3 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Lesson 4: Impact, Urgency and Prioritisation

Introduction

Support teams prioritise work by considering how many people or services are affected and how quickly action is needed.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of impact, urgency and prioritisation.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for impact, urgency and prioritisation.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: Impact measures the scale of disruption.

Key point: Urgency measures how quickly the issue needs attention.

Key point: A single learner with a workaround may be lower priority than a whole class unable to access the LMS.

Key point: Safety, security and major service failures require immediate escalation according to policy.

Key point: Priority should be based on service impact, not on who complains the loudest.

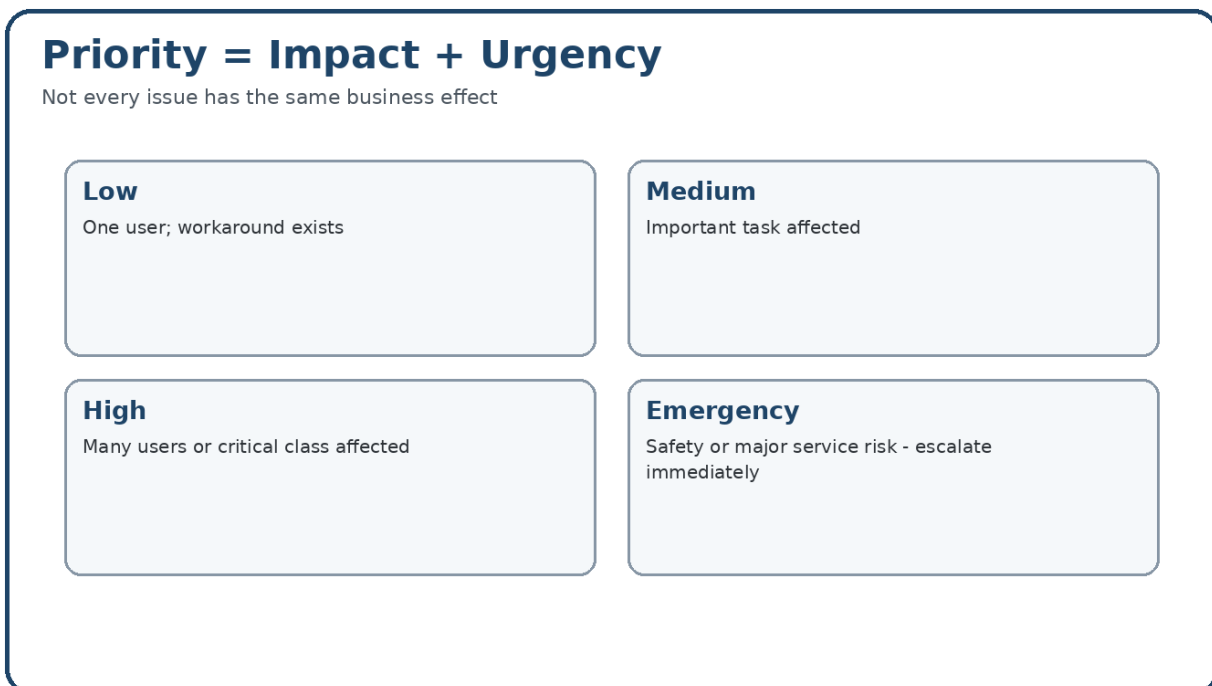


Figure 4: Instructional visual for Impact, Urgency and Prioritisation.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Rank four fictional incidents from low to high priority.
2. Explain the impact and urgency of each.
3. Choose a response target for classroom-critical issues.
4. Write one example where a low-impact issue is still urgent.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

If an entire Academy lab loses internet during an examination, its priority is higher than one optional application failing on one computer.

Review Questions

32. What is the main support goal in impact, urgency and prioritisation?
33. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
34. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
35. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 4 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Lesson 5: Troubleshooting Methodology

Introduction

Troubleshooting is a logical process of defining the symptom, checking likely causes, testing safely and verifying the result.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of troubleshooting methodology.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for troubleshooting methodology.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: Ask what changed, when the problem began and whether it affects one user or many.

Key point: Check simple external causes first.

Key point: Use approved built-in status information before installing extra tools.

Key point: Change one safe variable at a time.

Key point: Document every meaningful action and stop when specialist access is required.

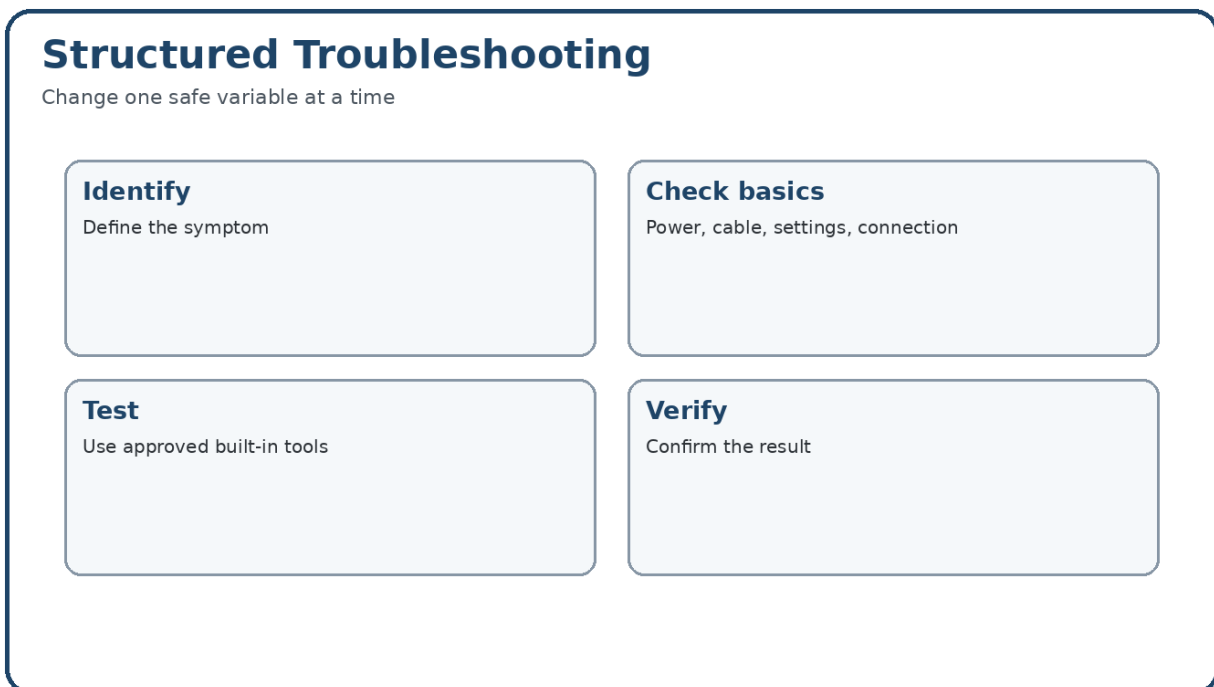


Figure 5: Instructional visual for Troubleshooting Methodology.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Use a fictional 'no sound' problem.
2. Write clarifying questions.
3. List safe checks such as volume and output device.
4. Choose one test at a time.
5. Write how you would verify success.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

A structured method prevents Academy support staff from randomly changing settings and creating new problems.

Review Questions

36. What is the main support goal in troubleshooting methodology?
37. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
38. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
39. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 5 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Lesson 6: Supporting Windows and Desktop Settings

Introduction

Many support requests involve ordinary desktop settings rather than failed hardware.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of supporting windows and desktop settings.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for supporting windows and desktop settings.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: Display issues may involve brightness, resolution, duplicate/extend mode or external display input.

Key point: Sound issues may involve mute, volume or wrong output device.

Key point: Storage issues may involve low free space or misplaced files.

Key point: Updates may require a restart.

Key point: Use normal system settings and respect administrator restrictions.

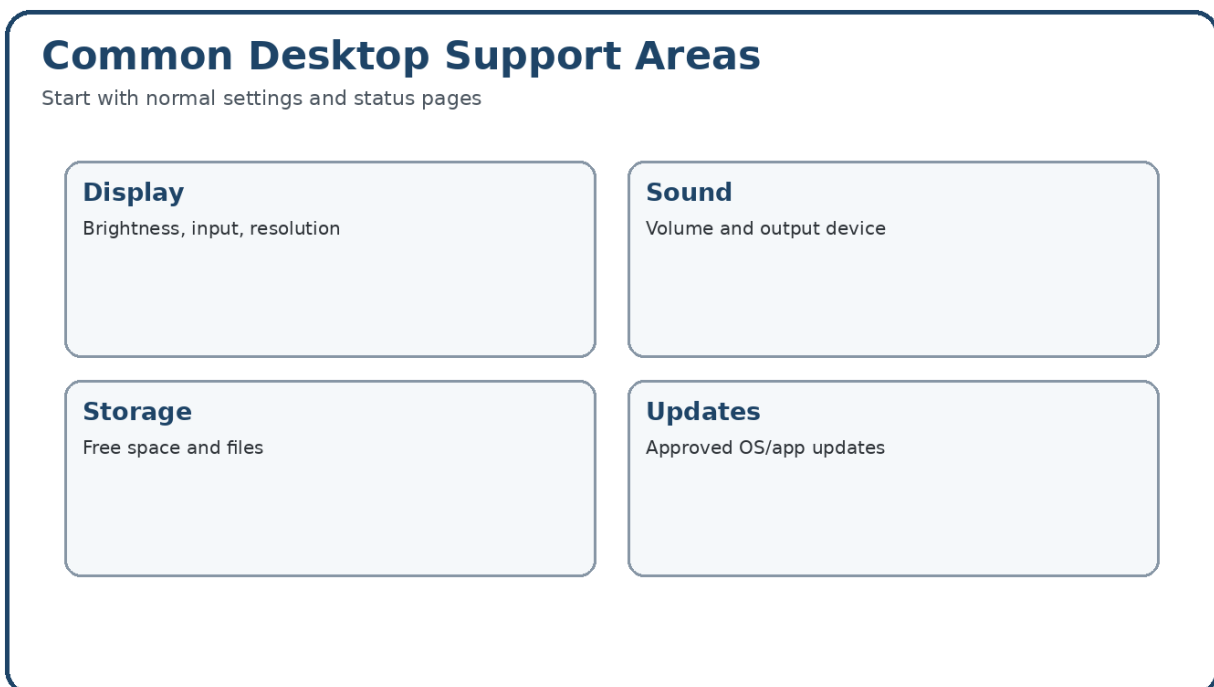


Figure 6: Instructional visual for Supporting Windows and Desktop Settings.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Open Windows Settings on an authorised computer.
2. Locate Display, Sound, Storage and Windows Update.
3. Record current settings without changing restricted options.
4. Change one harmless display scaling or volume setting if authorised, then restore it.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy first-line support can solve many classroom issues through standard Windows settings.

Review Questions

40. What is the main support goal in supporting windows and desktop settings?
41. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
42. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
43. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 6 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Lesson 7: Application Support Fundamentals

Introduction

Application support focuses on whether software opens, behaves normally and has the resources or permissions it legitimately needs.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of application support fundamentals.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for application support fundamentals.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: Confirm the correct application and version.

Key point: Check whether the issue affects one file or the whole application.

Key point: Save user work before restarting an application.

Key point: Use official update or repair options when authorised.

Key point: Do not disable security controls or install unknown patches to force an application to work.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Use a harmless document application.
2. Open a practice file.
3. Simulate a 'file not found' issue by moving a practice file to another folder.
4. Use search or Recent files to locate it.
5. Document the resolution.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy support may help learners locate assignments or confirm approved applications are updated.

Review Questions

44. What is the main support goal in application support fundamentals?
45. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
46. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
47. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 7 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Lesson 8: Printer and Peripheral Support

Introduction

Printers, keyboards, mice, webcams and projectors create common help-desk tickets.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of printer and peripheral support.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for printer and peripheral support.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: Check power and cable connections before assuming hardware failure.

Key point: Confirm the correct printer or output device is selected.

Key point: Check paper, queue and status messages.

Key point: For USB devices, reconnect only through normal external ports.

Key point: Damaged electrical parts or repeated mechanical faults should be escalated.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a fictional 'printer not printing' ticket.
2. Check selected printer, queue and paper status.
3. Create a 'mouse not working' checklist.
4. Create a 'projector no image' checklist.
5. Mark which conditions require technician escalation.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

A prepared peripheral checklist helps Academy instructors restore simple classroom equipment quickly.

Review Questions

48. What is the main support goal in printer and peripheral support?
49. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
50. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
51. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 8 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Lesson 9: Network and Internet Support Basics

Introduction

Connectivity support begins by separating device, local-network and wider-service problems.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of network and internet support basics.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for network and internet support basics.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: Confirm whether Wi-Fi or Ethernet is enabled and connected to the expected authorised network.

Key point: Check whether the issue affects one device or many.

Key point: Test access to an approved known service rather than random websites.

Key point: Restarting network infrastructure should be left to authorised administrators.

Key point: Do not scan, probe or attempt to bypass network controls.

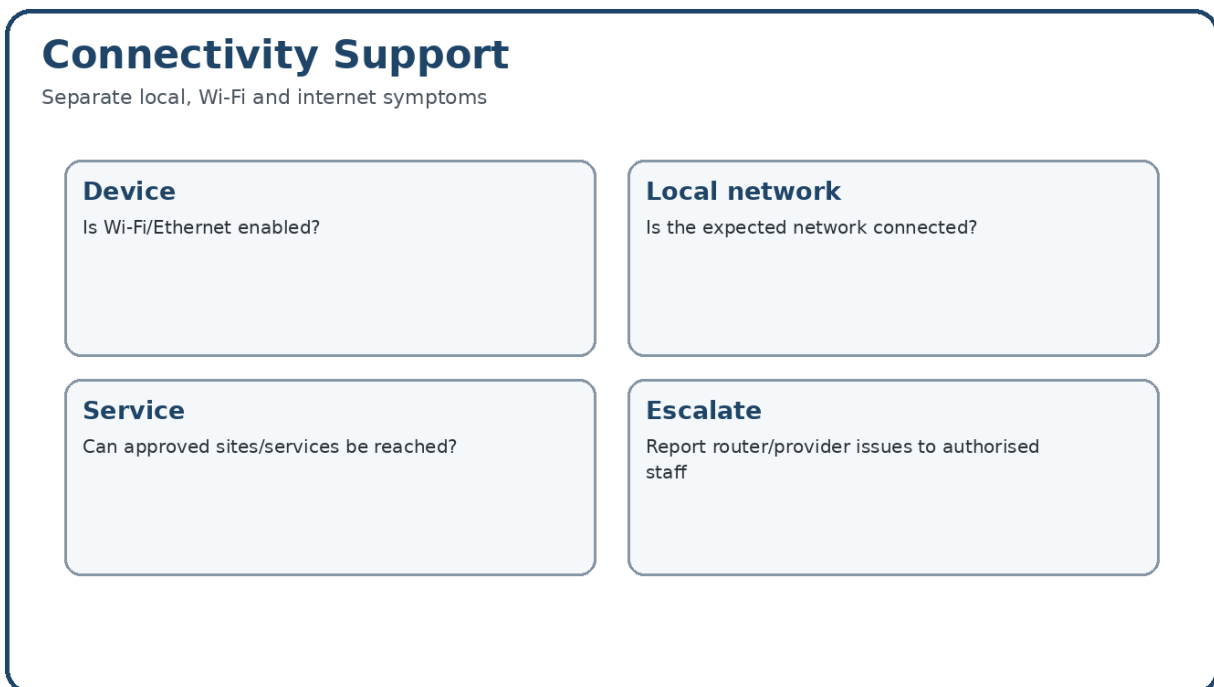


Figure 9: Instructional visual for Network and Internet Support Basics.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Identify whether an authorised computer uses Wi-Fi or Ethernet.
2. Record the connection status.
3. Use the normal network troubleshooter if available.
4. Compare a fictional one-device outage with a whole-lab outage.
5. Write the correct escalation path.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy support can determine whether one laptop lost Wi-Fi or the entire site has a provider outage.

Review Questions

52. What is the main support goal in network and internet support basics?
53. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
54. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
55. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 9 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Lesson 10: Account and Password Support

Introduction

Account support must protect user identity and credentials while restoring legitimate access.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of account and password support.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for account and password support.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: Never ask a user to tell you their password or one-time authentication code.

Key point: Use approved identity-verification and password-reset procedures.

Key point: Encourage users to enter credentials privately.

Key point: Account lockouts may require administrator action.

Key point: Suspicious account activity should be escalated to security or authorised administrators.

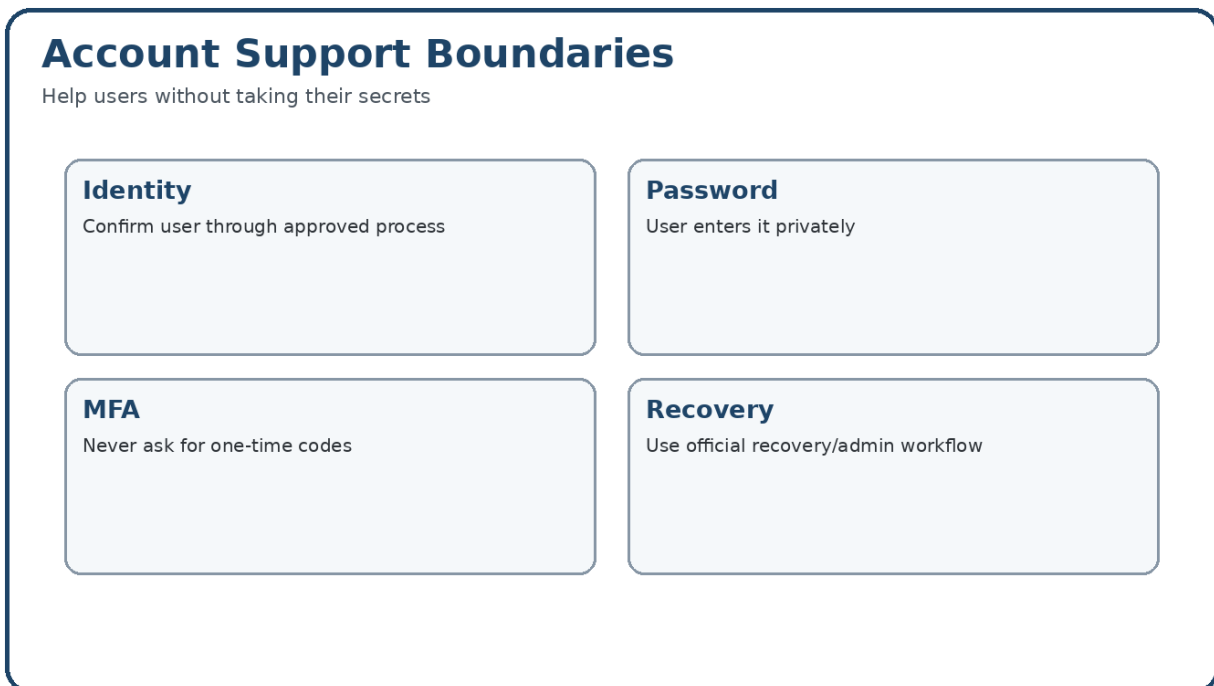


Figure 10: Instructional visual for Account and Password Support.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Write a safe password-reset conversation.
2. Identify information support staff should never request.
3. Locate the official account-recovery option for a practice service.
4. Create a fictional locked-account ticket.
5. Write an escalation note for suspicious sign-in activity.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy staff can guide learners to the official LMS password-reset process without knowing their passwords.

Review Questions

56. What is the main support goal in account and password support?
57. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
58. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
59. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 10 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Lesson 11: Email and Communication Support

Introduction

Support staff often help users with email setup, sending, attachments and mailbox organisation.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of email and communication support.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for email and communication support.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: Confirm internet connectivity before troubleshooting online email.

Key point: Check recipient address and attachment size for ordinary sending issues.

Key point: Explain CC/BCC and inbox organisation when needed.

Key point: Do not open suspicious attachments to 'test' them.

Key point: Phishing reports should follow the security process.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Draft a fictional ticket for 'attachment will not send'.
2. Check file size and connection status.
3. Write a user-friendly explanation.
4. Create a separate fictional phishing report and mark it for escalation.
5. Do not interact with suspicious links.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy support can help instructors attach approved course documents while routing suspicious messages to security.

Review Questions

60. What is the main support goal in email and communication support?
61. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
62. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
63. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 11 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Lesson 12: Remote Support and User Consent

Introduction

Remote support can be useful when staff cannot reach a device physically, but it requires consent, transparency and privacy.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of remote support and user consent.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for remote support and user consent.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: Use only organisation-approved remote-support tools.

Key point: Obtain the user's permission before starting.

Key point: Explain what you are doing and avoid unrelated personal files.

Key point: Ask the user to enter passwords themselves.

Key point: End the remote session when support is complete.

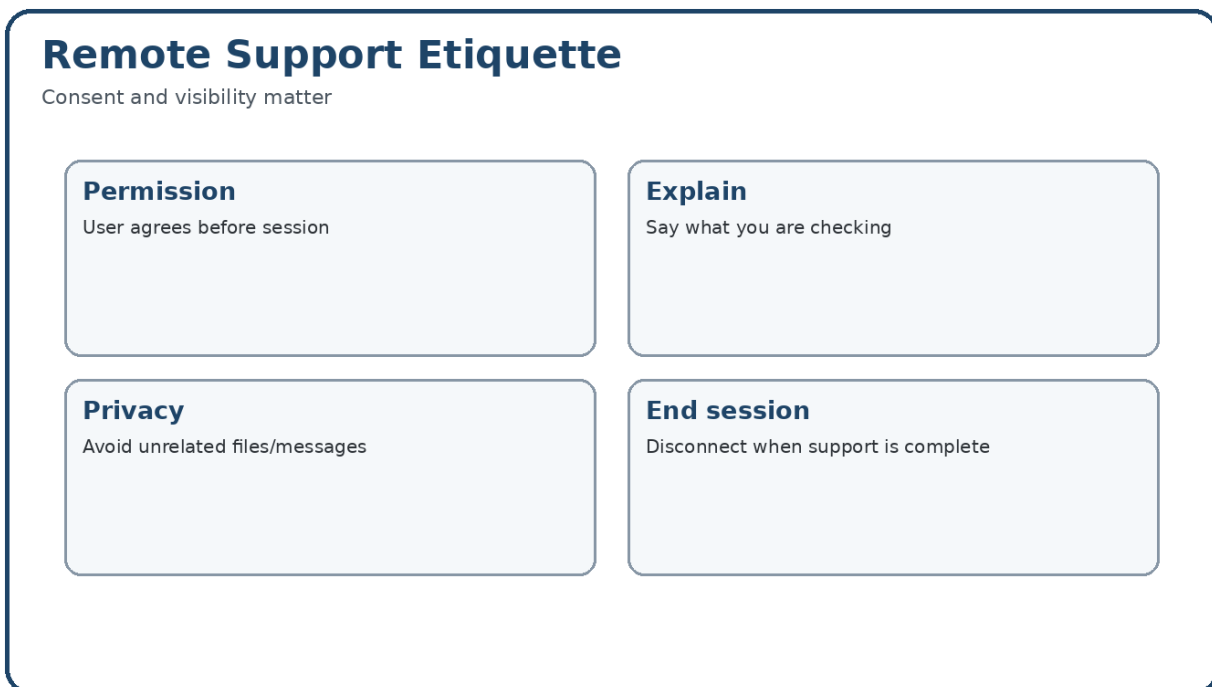


Figure 12: Instructional visual for Remote Support and User Consent.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Write a remote-support consent script.
2. Create a checklist for beginning a session.
3. Create a privacy checklist.
4. Write a closing message confirming the session has ended.
5. Explain when remote support should not be used.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy IT staff can remotely guide an instructor only through approved tools and with the instructor's knowledge.

Review Questions

64. What is the main support goal in remote support and user consent?
65. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
66. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
67. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 12 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Lesson 13: Customer Service and Communication Skills

Introduction

Users may be frustrated when technology blocks their work. Support professionals should communicate calmly and clearly.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of customer service and communication skills.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for customer service and communication skills.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: Acknowledge the problem without blaming the user.

Key point: Ask focused questions one at a time.

Key point: Avoid unnecessary technical jargon.

Key point: Give realistic updates when a case is taking longer.

Key point: Confirm the solution in language the user understands.

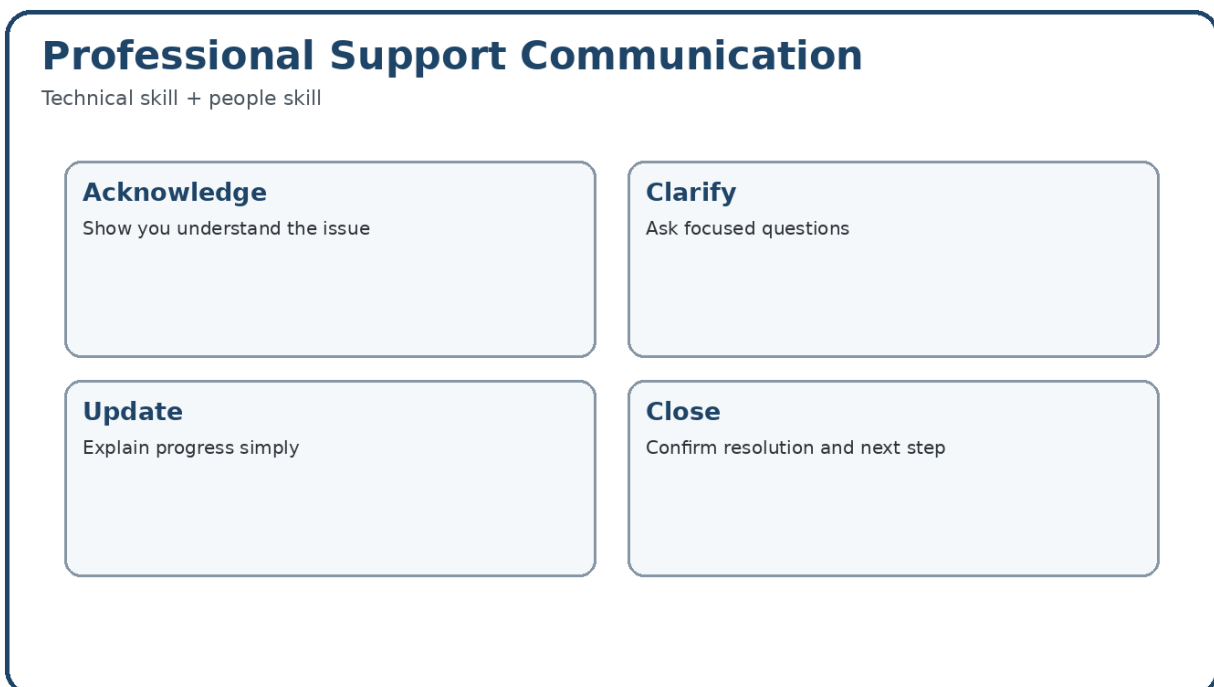


Figure 13: Instructional visual for Customer Service and Communication Skills.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Rewrite three technical statements in plain language.
2. Role-play a fictional support call with a classmate or instructor.
3. Ask three clarifying questions.
4. Write a short progress update.
5. Write a professional closure message.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Good communication helps Academy learners and instructors feel supported even when a technical issue needs escalation.

Review Questions

68. What is the main support goal in customer service and communication skills?
69. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
70. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
71. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 13 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Lesson 14: Security Awareness for IT Support

Introduction

Support staff are often the first to hear about suspicious emails, malware alerts, lost devices or unusual account behaviour.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of security awareness for it support.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for security awareness for it support.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: Do not investigate suspicious links or files beyond approved defensive procedures.

Key point: Preserve useful information such as time, device and visible alert message.

Key point: Escalate malware, credential theft, lost devices and possible data exposure promptly.

Key point: Do not promise secrecy when an organisational security process requires reporting.

Key point: Use least privilege and access only what is needed for the support task.

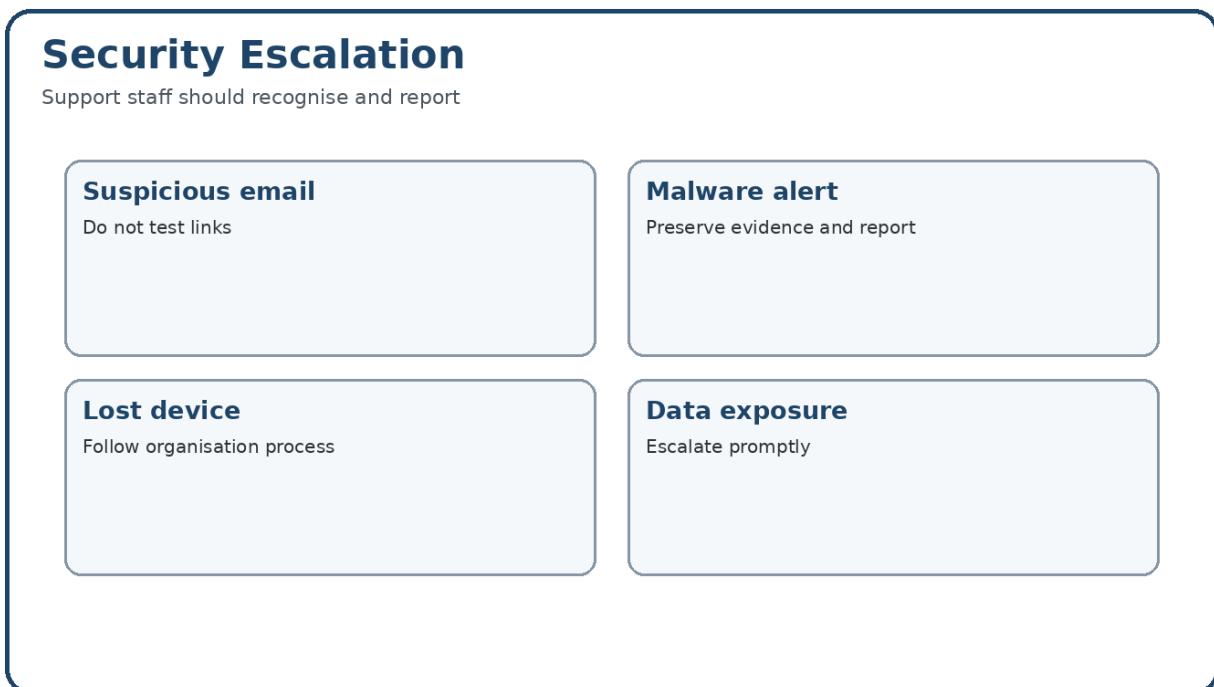


Figure 14: Instructional visual for Security Awareness for IT Support.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Review four fictional support tickets.
2. Identify which are ordinary IT issues and which require security escalation.
3. Write a safe incident note.
4. List evidence that can be recorded without opening suspicious content.
5. State who should receive the escalation in a fictional organisation.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

An Academy help desk should recognise a phishing report and send it to the authorised security contact rather than testing the link.

Review Questions

72. What is the main support goal in security awareness for IT support?
73. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
74. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
75. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 14 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Lesson 15: Escalation and Handover

Introduction

Escalation transfers a case to someone with the authority or expertise required to continue safely.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of escalation and handover.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for escalation and handover.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: Escalate when the issue exceeds your access, skill, time target or safety boundary.

Key point: Include symptoms, impact, actions already taken and results.

Key point: Avoid repeating failed steps without a reason.

Key point: Tell the user what happens next.

Key point: Keep ownership clear until the receiving team accepts the case.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a fictional escalation for a failed laptop battery.
2. Include ticket number, device, impact and checks performed.
3. Write a user update.
4. Create a second escalation for a suspected account compromise.
5. Compare the information needed in each.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy first-line staff can hand a hardware fault to a technician with enough information to avoid restarting the diagnosis from zero.

Review Questions

76. What is the main support goal in escalation and handover?
77. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
78. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
79. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 15 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Lesson 16: Knowledge Base and Self-Service Documentation

Introduction

A knowledge base turns repeated support solutions into clear reusable instructions.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of knowledge base and self-service documentation.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for knowledge base and self-service documentation.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: Use a specific problem-focused title.

Key point: Describe symptoms and prerequisites.

Key point: Write numbered safe steps.

Key point: Include what success looks like.

Key point: Review articles when software changes.

Key point: Do not publish internal credentials, private URLs or sensitive administrative details.

Knowledge Base Article

Turn repeated fixes into reusable guidance

Title

Describe the problem clearly

Symptoms

What the user sees

Steps

Safe authorised checks

Result

How to confirm success

Figure 16: Instructional visual for Knowledge Base and Self-Service Documentation.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Choose a common harmless issue such as 'How to select the correct printer'.
2. Write a title and symptom description.
3. Write five numbered steps.
4. Add a verification step.
5. Ask a classmate to follow the article and note unclear wording.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy can publish learner-facing help articles for login, course access and common classroom technology tasks.

Review Questions

80. What is the main support goal in knowledge base and self-service documentation?
81. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
82. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
83. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 16 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Lesson 17: Asset and Support Records

Introduction

IT support works better when devices and recurring problems can be tracked.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of asset and support records.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for asset and support records.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: Asset records can include device name, model, location, serial/asset number and warranty.

Key point: Ticket history can reveal repeated faults.

Key point: Maintenance and support records should use consistent identifiers.

Key point: Access to records should follow organisational permissions.

Key point: Passwords and unnecessary personal information do not belong in asset records.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create a fictional asset register for five computers.
2. Give each a unique asset ID.
3. Link two fictional tickets to one device.
4. Identify a repeated issue.
5. Write a replacement or maintenance recommendation.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

Academy management can use support history to decide whether a frequently failing computer should be repaired or replaced.

Review Questions

84. What is the main support goal in asset and support records?
85. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
86. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
87. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 17 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Lesson 18: Help-Desk Reporting and Service Improvement

Introduction

Support data can show workload, recurring problems and opportunities for training or preventive action.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of help-desk reporting and service improvement.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for help-desk reporting and service improvement.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: Useful measures include ticket volume, categories, resolution time and repeat incidents.

Key point: Metrics need context; a fast closure is not useful if the problem returns.

Key point: Recurring user questions may indicate a need for clearer training or documentation.

Key point: Reports should protect user privacy.

Key point: Service improvement should focus on reducing disruption and improving user experience.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create ten fictional tickets in a table.
2. Group them by category.
3. Count how many were resolved or escalated.
4. Identify the most common issue.
5. Recommend one improvement based on the data.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

If many Academy learners repeatedly ask how to upload assignments, a clearer guide may reduce future tickets.

Review Questions

88. What is the main support goal in help-desk reporting and service improvement?
89. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
90. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
91. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 18 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Lesson 19: Final IT Support Help-Desk Project

Introduction

The final project combines ticketing, prioritisation, troubleshooting, communication, escalation and reporting.

Learning Objectives

- Explain the main principles of final it support help-desk project.
- Complete a safe first-line support practical for final it support help-desk project.
- Document and communicate the result professionally.

Teaching Content

Key point: Use only fictional users, devices and support cases.

Key point: Apply safe first-line checks rather than invasive or unauthorised actions.

Key point: Show clear communication at opening, progress and closure.

Key point: Escalate security, electrical and specialist faults appropriately.

Key point: Summarise lessons that could improve future support.



Figure 19: Instructional visual for Final IT Support Help-Desk Project.

Step-by-Step Guided Practical

1. Create five fictional tickets covering software, hardware, network, account and security categories.
2. Assign impact, urgency and priority.
3. Write safe troubleshooting steps for each.
4. Resolve at least two fictional first-line cases and escalate the others appropriately.
5. Write user updates and closure notes.
6. Produce a one-page help-desk summary report.

Ethan Digital Academy Case Study

This project models a small professional service desk supporting Ethan Digital Academy operations.

Review Questions

92. What is the main support goal in final it support help-desk project?
93. State two correct first-line practices from this lesson.
94. What action would require escalation or extra authorisation?
95. What information should be recorded in the support ticket?

Assignment

Complete the Lesson 19 fictional support scenario. Submit a short ticket containing the symptom, impact, safe checks, result and next action. Do not include passwords, codes or real private information.

Final Practical Project - 100 Marks

Component	Marks	Requirement
Ticket quality	15	Five clear fictional tickets with complete facts.
Prioritisation	10	Impact and urgency applied consistently.
Troubleshooting	20	Safe logical first-line checks.
User communication	15	Professional opening, updates and closure.
Account/privacy practice	10	No collection of passwords or one-time codes.
Escalation	15	Correct handover for specialist/security cases.
Knowledge article	5	One reusable help article.
Service report	10	Summary, recurring issue and improvement recommendation.

Course Quiz - 30 Questions

1. What is IT support?
2. What is first-line support?
3. What is a support ticket?
4. Name four facts that belong in a ticket.
5. Why should passwords not be stored in tickets?
6. What is impact?
7. What is urgency?
8. Why should priority not depend on who complains loudest?
9. What is the first step in troubleshooting?
10. Why change one safe variable at a time?
11. Name two common Windows support areas.
12. Why should user work be saved before restarting an application?
13. Name three peripheral support checks.
14. How can you tell whether a network problem affects one device or many?
15. Why should learners not scan or probe networks?
16. Should a support worker ask for a user's password?
17. What is the safe way to handle MFA codes?
18. What should happen if suspicious account activity is reported?
19. Name two ordinary email support checks.
20. Why should suspicious attachments not be opened for testing?
21. What is remote support consent?
22. Why should a remote session end when support is complete?
23. Name two good customer-service behaviours.
24. What does least privilege mean in support work?
25. When should a case be escalated?
26. What information belongs in a handover?
27. What is a knowledge base?

28. What is an asset register?
29. Name two useful help-desk metrics.
30. Why are recurring issues useful for service improvement?

Final Examination - 100 Marks

Section A - Service Desk Foundations (20 marks)

Explain IT support roles, ticketing, impact, urgency and prioritisation.

Section B - Troubleshooting and Desktop Support (20 marks)

Describe a safe troubleshooting method and apply it to common Windows, application and peripheral issues.

Section C - Connectivity and Accounts (20 marks)

Explain first-line network checks, legitimate account recovery, email support and privacy boundaries.

Section D - Communication, Security and Escalation (20 marks)

Explain customer service, remote-support consent, security awareness and professional handover.

Section E - Support Operations (20 marks)

Design a simple knowledge base, asset register and service report for Ethan Digital Academy.

Course Completion Outcome

After successful completion, the learner should be able to operate as a safe beginner first-line IT support assistant: log and prioritise tickets, diagnose common user problems systematically, support desktop applications and peripherals, perform basic connectivity checks, guide legitimate account recovery without handling secrets, communicate clearly, document work, escalate security or specialist issues and contribute to a simple knowledge base and service report.

Professional Practice Checklist

- Work only on authorised devices and accounts.
- Never ask for a user's password or one-time code.
- Use safe standard checks before advanced changes.
- Do not probe networks or test suspicious links/files.
- Explain actions clearly to the user.
- Document symptoms, actions and results.
- Escalate electrical, security and specialist faults promptly.